Code Companion — Design Standards & Guidelines

Version: 1.0 **Last Updated:** 2026-03-14 **Aesthetic:** Cyberpunk Neon Glass Morphism **Theme:** Dark-only

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1. Brand Identity

Core Aesthetic

Code Companion uses a **cyberpunk neon glass morphism** aesthetic — deep navy backgrounds with frosted glass surfaces, indigo neon accents, and subtle particle effects. The visual language communicates "intelligent, premium, approachable tech tool."

Logo & Naming

- **Product:** Th3rdAI Code Companion
- **Tagline:** Vibe Coder Edition
- **Theme Color:** `#0c0f1a` (deep navy)
- **Favicon:** `/favicon.png` (PNG format)
- **Apple Touch Icon:** `/apple-touch-icon.png`

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2. Color System

2.1 Background Palette

Token	Value	Usage
`--color-base`	`#0c0f1a`	Body background, deepest layer
`--color-surface`	`#141829`	Card surfaces, panels
`--color-surface-light`	`#1e2440`	Elevated surfaces, hover states

2.2 Brand Colors

Token	Value	Usage
`--color-brand`	`#6366f1`	Primary brand — indigo
`--color-brand-blue`	`#3b82f6`	Secondary — blue
`--color-brand-purple`	`#8b5cf6`	Tertiary — purple (gradients)
`--color-cyan`	`#38bdf8`	Accent — cyan highlights
`--color-neon`	`#6366f1`	Neon glow source
`--color-neon-glow`	`rgba(99, 102, 241, 0.4)`	Neon glow with alpha

2.3 Text Colors

Class	Hex	Usage
`text-white` / `text-slate-50`	`#f8fafc`	High-emphasis headings

`text-slate-100`	`#f1f5f9`	Primary body text
`text-slate-200`	`#e2e8f0`	Standard body text
`text-slate-300`	`#cbd5e1`	Secondary text
`text-slate-400`	`#94a3b8`	Labels, helpers, placeholders
`text-slate-500`	`#64748b`	Muted, tertiary
`text-slate-600`	`#475569`	Very muted, disabled
`text-indigo-300`	`#a5b4fc`	Accent text, active states
`text-indigo-400`	`#818cf8`	Links, interactive accent

2.4 Status Colors

Status	Background	Border	Text	Usage
Success	`bg-emerald-500/20`	`border-emerald-500/40`	`text-emerald-300`	Grade A, success states
Good	`bg-blue-500/20`	`border-blue-500/40`	`text-blue-300`	Grade B, info
Warning	`bg-amber-500/20`	`border-amber-500/40`	`text-amber-300`	Grade C, caution
Caution	`bg-orange-500/20`	`border-orange-500/40`	`text-orange-300`	Grade D, needs work
Danger	`bg-red-500/20`	`border-red-500/40`	`text-red-300`	Grade F, errors, critical

2.5 Grade Color Mapping

Grade	Semantic	BG	Border	Text	Ring
A	Excellent	`emerald-500/20`	`emerald-500/40`	`emerald-300`	`emerald-500`
B	Good	`blue-500/20`	`blue-500/40`	`blue-300`	`blue-500`
C	Okay	`amber-500/20`	`amber-500/40`	`amber-300`	`amber-500`
D	Needs Work	`orange-500/20`	`orange-500/40`	`orange-300`	`orange-500`
F	Fail	`red-500/20`	`red-500/40`	`red-300`	`red-500`

2.6 Severity Colors

Severity	Text	Background	Border
Critical	`text-red-400`	`bg-red-500/15`	`border-red-500/30`
High	`text-orange-400`	`bg-orange-500/15`	`border-orange-500/30`
Medium	`text-amber-400`	`bg-amber-500/15`	`border-amber-500/30`
Low	`text-blue-400`	`bg-blue-500/15`	`border-blue-500/30`

2.7 Gradients

```
Primary CTA:     linear-gradient(135deg, #3b82f6, #6366f1, #8b5cf6)
Brand Text:      bg-gradient-to-r from-blue-400 via-indigo-400 to-purple-400
Strong Brand:    bg-gradient-to-r from-blue-500 via-indigo-500 to-purple-500
Page Background: bg-gradient-to-br from-base via-surface to-surface-light
Mesh (subtle):   Radial gradients — blue(0.08), cyan(0.06), purple(0.05) opacity
```

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3. Typography

3.1 Font Stack

Role	Family	Weights	CSS Variable
UI / Body	Inter	300, 400, 500, 600, 700	`--font-sans`
Code / Mono	JetBrains Mono	400, 500	`--font-mono`

Google Fonts Import:

```
Inter:wght@300;400;500;600;700
JetBrains Mono:wght@400;500
```

3.2 Type Scale

Element	Size	Weight	Color	Class
App Title	`text-base` (16px)	700	Gradient (blue-indigo-purple)	`font-bold bg-clip-text`
Modal Title	`text-lg` (18px)	700	`slate-100`	`font-bold text-slate-100`
Section Title	`text-sm` (14px)	600	`slate-200`	`font-semibold text-slate-200`
Body	`text-sm` (14px)	400	`slate-200` / `slate-300`	`text-slate-200`
Label	`text-xs` (12px)	500	`slate-400`	`font-medium text-slate-400`
Caption	`text-xs` (12px)	400	`slate-500`	`text-slate-500`
Badge	`text-[9px]` / `text-[10px]`	700	Varies	`font-bold`
Code	`text-sm` (14px)	400	`slate-200`	`font-mono`

3.3 Prose Styles (Markdown Content)

Element	Size	Weight	Color
h2	1.15rem	700	`#a5b4fc` (indigo-300)

h3	1rem	600	`#e2e8f0` (slate-200)
p	inherit	400	inherit, `line-height: 1.6`
code (inline)	0.85em	400	`bg: #334155`, `px: 0.4rem`
pre (block)	inherit	400	`bg: #0c0f1a`, `border: indigo-500/15`
strong	inherit	700	`#e2e8f0`

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4. Glass Morphism System

The core visual language. Three tiers of glass effects.

4.1 Glass Variants

Class	Background	Blur	Border	Usage
`.glass`	`rgba(20, 24, 41, 0.6)`	`blur(16px)`	`rgba(148, 163, 184, 0.08)`	Default cards, info boxes
`.glass-heavy`	`rgba(20, 24, 41, 0.85)`	`blur(24px)`	`rgba(148, 163, 184, 0.1)`	Headers, footers, modals, sidebar
`.glass-neon`	`rgba(20, 24, 41, 0.5)`	`blur(20px)`	`rgba(99, 102, 241, 0.25)`	User messages, accent cards, toasts

4.2 Neon Effects

Class	Effect	Usage
`.neon-border`	Indigo border + outer glow shadow	Modal containers, emphasis cards
`.neon-text`	Indigo text-shadow (10px + 20px)	Headings, accent text
`.neon-glow-sm`	Subtle box-shadow glow	Active tab indicators

4.3 Glow Animations

Class	Animation	Duration	Usage
`.glow-pulse`	Box-shadow pulses (5px to 45px)	3s infinite	Status indicators, active badges
`.border-glow`	Border color fades (0.3 to 0.7 opacity)	3s infinite	Focused inputs, active elements
`.shimmer`	Background position shift	3s linear infinite	Loading states

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5. Component Library

5.1 Buttons

Primary (Neon CTA)

```
Class: btn-neon
Background: linear-gradient(135deg, #3b82f6, #6366f1, #8b5cf6)
Border: 1px solid rgba(129, 140, 248, 0.5)
Shadow: 0 0 15px rgba(99, 102, 241, 0.3), 0 4px 12px rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.3)
Hover: shadow intensifies, border brightens, translateY(-1px)
Active: translateY(0), reduced shadow
Pairs with: rounded-xl, px-4, py-2.5, font-medium
```

Secondary (Glass)

```
Class: glass
Text: text-slate-400 hover:text-indigo-300
Hover: hover:bg-indigo-500/10
Pairs with: rounded-lg, px-2.5, py-1.5, text-xs
```

Danger

```
Text: text-red-400/70 hover:text-red-400
Border: border-red-500/20
Hover: hover:bg-red-500/10
Pairs with: rounded-lg, px-2.5, py-1.5, text-xs
```

Disabled State

```
All buttons: disabled:opacity-50, cursor-not-allowed
```

5.2 Inputs

Text Input / Textarea

```
Class: input-glow
Background: rgba(15, 23, 42, 0.8)
Border: 1px solid rgba(71, 85, 105, 0.5)
Focus: border-color rgba(99, 102, 241, 0.6) + box-shadow glow
Text: text-slate-100 or text-slate-200
Placeholder: placeholder-slate-500
Pairs with: rounded-lg (inputs), rounded-xl (textarea), px-4, py-3
```

Tag Input

```
Container: flex flex-wrap gap-1.5 input-glow rounded-xl px-3 py-2 min-h-[42px]
Tags: bg-indigo-500/20 text-indigo-300 border-indigo-500/30 rounded-full px-2.5 py-0.5
Remove: text-indigo-400 hover:text-indigo-200
```

5.3 Tabs

Mode Tabs

```
Container: glass border-b border-slate-700/30 px-3 py-2 flex flex-wrap gap-1.5
Active:   bg-indigo-600/30 text-indigo-300 border border-indigo-500/40 font-medium
neon-glow-sm
Inactive: text-slate-400 hover:bg-indigo-500/10 hover:text-slate-200
Locked:   opacity-60 text-slate-500 hover:opacity-80
PRO Badge: text-[9px] font-bold text-indigo-400 bg-indigo-500/20 px-1 py-0.5 rounded
```

Settings Tabs

```
Active:   bg-indigo-600/40 text-indigo-200
Inactive: bg-slate-700/50 text-slate-500 hover:text-slate-300
```

5.4 Modals

```
Overlay:   fixed inset-0 bg-black/60 z-50 flex items-center justify-center p-4
Container: glass-heavy rounded-2xl w-full max-w-{sm|md} p-6 neon-border
Close:     text-slate-400 hover:text-white text-xl transition-colors
ARIA:      role="dialog" aria-label="..." aria-modal="true"
```

5.5 Toast Notifications

```
Position: fixed bottom-6 right-6 z-50
Style:    glass-neon text-slate-200 text-sm px-4 py-2.5 rounded-xl shadow-lg fade-in
Duration: 3000ms auto-dismiss
ARIA:     role="status" aria-live="polite"
```

5.6 Banners / Alerts

Type	Background	Border	Text
Warning	`bg-amber-500/10`	`border-amber-500/30`	`text-amber-300`
Error	`bg-red-500/10`	`border-red-500/30`	`text-red-400`
Success	`bg-green-500/10`	`border-green-500/30`	`text-green-400`
Info	`bg-blue-500/10`	`border-blue-500/30`	`text-blue-400`

5.7 Cards

```
Standard: glass rounded-xl border border-slate-700/30 p-4
Hover:    hover:border-slate-600/50
Finding:  glass rounded-xl border border-slate-700/30 p-3 space-y-2
```

5.8 Badges

Grade Badge (Large)

```
Size: w-20 h-20 text-4xl (lg), w-12 h-12 text-2xl (md), w-8 h-8 text-base (sm)
Style: rounded-2xl border-2 flex items-center justify-center font-bold
Colors: Per grade mapping (Section 2.5)
```

Severity Pill

```
Style: text-[10px] uppercase font-semibold px-2 py-0.5 rounded-full border
Colors: Per severity mapping (Section 2.6)
```

PRO Badge

```
Inline: text-[9px] font-bold text-indigo-400 bg-indigo-500/20 px-1 py-0.5 rounded
Full:   text-xs font-bold text-indigo-400 bg-indigo-500/20 px-2 py-1 rounded-full
```

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6. Layout & Spacing

6.1 Page Structure

```
Body: bg-base text-slate-50 font-sans
Root: h-screen flex flex-col overflow-hidden
Header: glass-heavy, fixed height
Main: flex-1 flex overflow-hidden
Sidebar: glass-heavy, w-72 (desktop), full overlay (mobile)
Content: flex-1 flex flex-col min-w-0
```

6.2 Spacing Scale

Token	Value	Usage
`gap-1` / `p-1`	4px	Tight inline elements
`gap-1.5`	6px	Tab groups, badge spacing
`gap-2` / `p-2`	8px	Standard inline gaps
`gap-3` / `p-3`	12px	Card content padding
`gap-4` / `p-4`	16px	Section padding, card padding
`gap-6` / `p-6`	24px	Modal padding, section spacing
`mb-4`	16px	Between form fields
`mb-6`	24px	Between sections

6.3 Border Radius Scale

Class	Value	Usage
`rounded-lg`	8px	Inputs, small cards, buttons
`rounded-xl`	12px	Cards, modals, textarea

`rounded-2xl`	16px	Large accent elements, splash buttons
`rounded-full`	9999px	Pills, badges, status dots

6.4 Z-Index Scale

Layer	Value	Usage
`z-10`	10	Floating elements within content
`z-20`	20	Sidebar, panels
`z-30`	30	Sticky headers
`z-40`	40	Tooltips, dropdowns
`z-50`	50	Modals, overlays, toasts

6.5 Responsive Breakpoints

Prefix	Min Width	Usage
(none)	0px	Mobile-first base
`sm:`	640px	Small tablets
`md:`	768px	Tablets
`lg:`	1024px	Desktop
`xl:`	1280px	Large desktop

Key responsive patterns:

- Mode tabs: `text-xs sm:text-sm`, `px-2 sm:px-3`, `gap-1.5 sm:gap-2`
- Sidebar: Full overlay on mobile, fixed panel on desktop
- Content padding: `px-3 sm:px-4`

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7. Animations & Transitions

7.1 Micro-Interactions

Animation	Duration	Easing	Usage
Color transitions	200ms	ease	Hover states, tab switches
Fade in	300ms	ease-out	New elements, messages
Button press	instant	—	`translateY(0)` on `:active`
Button hover lift	200ms	ease	`translateY(-1px)` on `:hover`

7.2 Ambient Animations

Animation	Duration	Usage
`glow-pulse`	3s infinite	Status dots, active indicators
`border-glow`	3s infinite	Focused inputs, active elements
`shimmer`	3s linear infinite	Loading states
`pulse-dot`	1.4s infinite	Typing indicator dots

7.3 Transition Classes

```
Default:     transition-colors (color changes only)
All props:   transition-all (size, position, color)
Transform:   transition-transform (movement only)
Duration:    200ms default (Tailwind default)
```

7.4 Accessibility

```
@media (prefers-reduced-motion: reduce) {
  * { animation-duration: 0.01ms !important; transition-duration: 0.01ms !important;
}
}
```

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8. Icons

8.1 Icon Library

Primary: Lucide React (`lucide-react` v0.577.0)

Standard Size: `w-4 h-4` (16px) for inline, `w-5 h-5` (20px) for toolbar

8.2 Commonly Used Icons

Category	Icons
Navigation	`ChevronLeft`, `ChevronRight`, `PanelLeft`, `X`
Actions	`Plus`, `Download`, `Upload`, `Copy`, `Save`, `Trash`, `Edit`
Status	`CheckCircle`, `AlertCircle`, `AlertTriangle`, `Wifi`, `WifiOff`
Content	`FileText`, `FolderOpen`, `BookOpen`, `History`, `Settings`
Modes	`MessageCircle`, `Lightbulb`, `Bug`, `Sparkles`, `Wrench`, `Shield`

8.3 Mode Tab Icons

Mode tabs currently use **emoji icons** for a friendly, approachable feel:

Mode	Icon	Tier

Chat	`\ud83d\udcac`	Free
Explain This	`\ud83d\udca1`	Free
Safety Check	`\ud83d\udc1b`	Free
Clean Up	`\u2728`	Free
Code to Plain English	`\ud83d\udccb`	Free
Idea to Code Spec	`\ud83d\udd27`	Free
Review	`\ud83d\udcdd`	Free
Prompting	`\ud83c\udfaf`	Free
Skillz	`\u26a1`	Pro
Agentic	`\ud83e\udd16`	Pro
Create	`\ud83d\udee0\ufe0f`	Free

> ***Design Note:*** *Emojis are used deliberately for mode tabs to maintain the friendly "vibe coder" personality. All other UI elements use Lucide SVG icons.*

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9. 3D & Visual Effects

9.1 Three.js Particles

Component	Purpose	Props
`ParticleField`	Ambient floating particles	`particleCount`, `speed`, `color`
`FloatingGeometry`	Animated 3D shapes in header	`shapeCount`
`ParticleBurst`	Send button feedback	`trigger`

9.2 Spline Scenes

Component	Purpose
`SplashScreen`	Full-screen intro with 3D scene
`HeaderScene`	Dynamic header visual
`EmptyStateScene`	Mode-specific empty states

9.3 Status Indicators

Component	Purpose	Props
`OrbitingBadge`	Connection status	`status: streaming/online/offline`
`TokenCounter`	Holographic token/duration display	Stats data

`TypingIndicator3D`	3D loading dots	—

9.4 Performance

- Particle count adjusts for mobile devices
- Spline scenes lazy-load with error boundaries
- All 3D components respect `prefers-reduced-motion`

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10. Accessibility

10.1 Focus States

```
*:focus-visible {
  outline: 2px solid #6366f1;
  outline-offset: 2px;
  border-radius: 4px;
}
```

10.2 ARIA Patterns

Pattern	Implementation
Modals	`role="dialog"`, `aria-modal="true"`, `aria-label`
Toasts	`role="status"`, `aria-live="polite"`
Icon buttons	`aria-label="descriptive text"`
Tabs	Click handlers with visual active state
Skip link	`.skip-link` class, hidden until focused

10.3 Color Contrast

- Body text (`slate-200` on `base`): exceeds 4.5:1
- Secondary text (`slate-400` on `base`): exceeds 4.5:1
- Accent text (`indigo-300` on `base`): exceeds 4.5:1
- Never use color alone as the only indicator

10.4 Scrollbar

```
.scrollbar-thin::-webkit-scrollbar { width: 6px; }
.scrollbar-thin::-webkit-scrollbar-thumb { background: #475569; border-radius: 3px;
}
.scrollbar-thin::-webkit-scrollbar-thumb:hover { background: #64748b; }
```

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11. Technical Stack

Layer	Technology	Version

Build	Vite	7.3.1
CSS	Tailwind CSS	v4.2.1
UI Framework	React	18
Icons	Lucide React	0.577.0
3D	Three.js / Spline	Latest
Fonts	Google Fonts (Inter, JetBrains Mono)	—

CSS Architecture

Tailwind v4 with `@import "tailwindcss"` and `@theme` block for custom properties. All custom utility classes defined in `src/index.css` using standard CSS (not `@apply`).

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12. Quick Reference Card

Do

- Use `.glass` / `.glass-heavy` / `.glass-neon` for all surfaces
- Use `.btn-neon` for primary CTAs
- Use `.input-glow` for all form inputs
- Use `text-slate-{200-400}` for text hierarchy
- Use indigo (`#6366f1`) as the primary accent
- Use Lucide icons at `w-4 h-4` for UI elements
- Use `rounded-lg` for inputs, `rounded-xl` for cards, `rounded-2xl` for accents
- Use `transition-colors` for hover states (200ms)
- Use opacity modifiers (`/20` , `/30` , `/40`) for layered depth
- Respect `prefers-reduced-motion`

Don't

- Don't use flat backgrounds without glass blur
- Don't use colors outside the established palette
- Don't mix icon libraries (stick to Lucide)
- Don't use `transition-all` when `transition-colors` suffices
- Don't add new z-index values outside the scale (10, 20, 30, 40, 50)
- Don't use light mode styles (dark-only app)
- Don't use animations longer than 300ms for micro-interactions
- Don't use text smaller than `text-xs` (12px) except badges